

IMMERSIVE FLOW FUELS SATISFACTION AND ATTITUDES IN ADVERGAMES

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1. INTRODUCTION

Advergaming, the fusion of advertising and gaming, is becoming a key marketing tool, especially in emerging markets like South Africa. With the widespread use of smartphones and the popularity of mobile gaming, brands are leveraging advergames to connect with younger, tech-savvy audiences like Generation Z and Millennials (referred to as younger consumers). These games are an immersive way for brands to engage consumers, build brand awareness, influence brand attitudes, and drive purchase intentions. By creating "flow" experience - where players become deeply engaged - advergames enhance consumer satisfaction, leading to positive brand attitudes and stronger brand loyalty, making them a valuable strategy in today's digital landscape.



6. RESULTS

The p-values for all constructs were below 0.05, indicating a deviation from normal distribution. However, normality was assumed under the Central Limit Theorem due to the sample size. Each Cronbach alpha of the constructs was above 0.7 indicating reliability. Furthermore, the KMO values for all constructs were above 0.6 acceptable for sampling adequacy and the Bartlett's test of Sphericity identified a p-value of 0.000 (below 0.05) indicating that EFA was an appropriate tool for the study.

Regression analysis shows a significant positive relationship among all constructs in the model. Brand attitude is the strongest predictor of purchase intention, followed by flow experience as a predictor of satisfaction.

9. REFERENCES

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2. PROBLEM STATEMENT

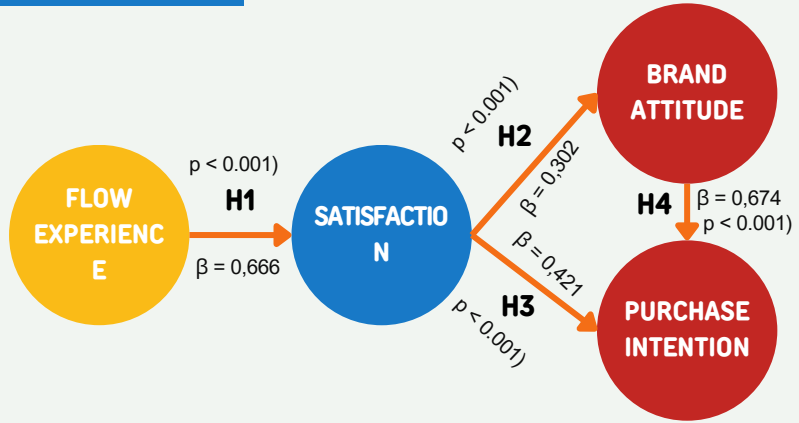
Current research indicates that adver gaming can engage consumers and create immersive brand experiences, enhancing satisfaction and drive purchase intentions, yet most studies focus on developed markets and general contexts. There is limited brand-specific research on adver games' effectiveness, and none in the fast-food sector, particularly among young consumers in emerging markets. competitive fast-food landscape, where young, tech-savvy consumers face information overload, adver games present a unique opportunity to capture attention, build brand affinity, and improve satisfaction, ultimately boosting brand attitudes and purchase intentions.

3. OBJECTIVES

The **main objective** is to measure the effectiveness of mobile adver gaming among young consumers, in emerging markets by examining how flow, satisfaction, brand attitude, and purchase intention predicts consumer responses.

The **research question**, is: "How does immersive flow experiences predict satisfaction, brand attitudes and purchase intention in adver games among young consumers?"

6.1 MODEL



4. LITERATURE REVIEW

Flow theory is used as a foundational framework, as it impacts customer satisfaction, which influences brand attitude and purchase intention (Csikszentmihalyi, 1975).

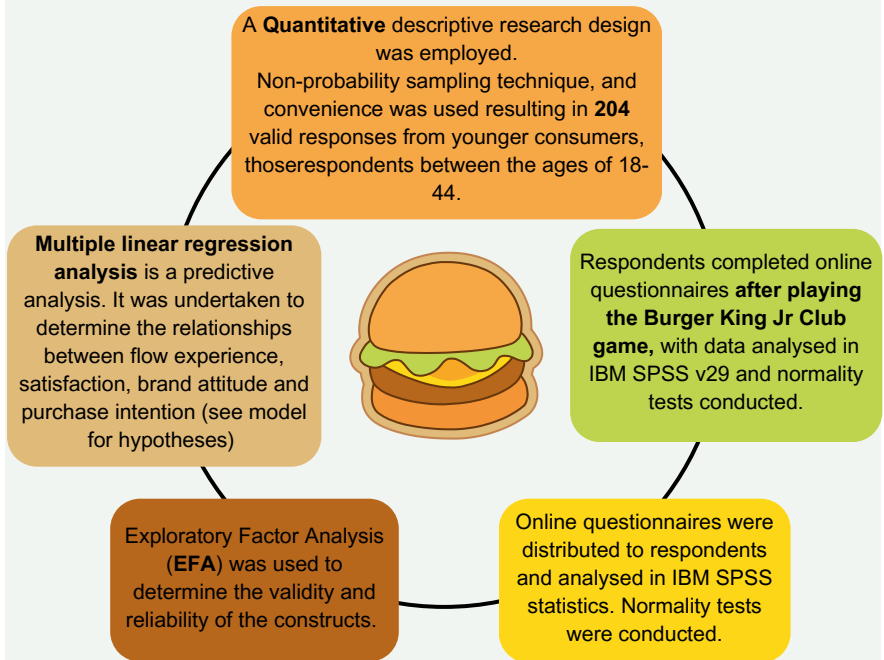
- Key findings from theories:**
- Deep immersion in games enhances consumer engagement and satisfaction (Güngör & Çadırcı, 2019).
 - Positive experiences in adver games can improve consumer perceptions of a brand (Keller & Swaminathan, 2020).
 - Higher satisfaction from gaming leads to increased likelihood of purchasing the advertised products (Dash, Kiefer & Paul, 2021).
 - The use of game-like elements can make advertising more engaging for consumers (Sreejesh, Ghosh & Dwivedi, 2021).



7. RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Optimise Game Design to Enable Flow Experience:** Enable players to experience flow via progressive difficulty, clear objectives and real-time feedback
- **Integrate Reward Systems to Drive Satisfaction and Engagement (Attitudes and Purchase Intention):** Adver games should include rewards and encourage increased play to increase satisfaction and foster a positive brand attitude
- **Personalised Content for Enhanced Brand Engagement:** Adver games that allow social interaction (via **multiplayer mode**) enhance customer engagement.
- **Continuous Measurement and Optimisation through Data Analytics to Improve Brand Attitude and Purchase Intention:** employ data analytic tools (**AI-4IR**) to monitor player behaviours, satisfaction levels, and flow experiences in real time and **analyse metrics such as session duration and game completion rates**

5. METHODOLOGY



8. CONCLUSION

This study supports the effectiveness of the Burger King Jr Club mobile advergame on fast food branding in South Africa

20.8% of respondents experienced flow while playing the Burger King advergame

Managerial implications: South African fast food marketers now have the insights to prioritise player flow experience and satisfaction in adver games

Ensure consistent branding, rewards and advergame availability across geographic locations

Addressing SDG 9 of industry, innovation and infrastructure

Limitations:

- Bias towards South Africans with internet access.
- Limited data collection timeframe.
- Geographical constraints, **mostly Gauteng participants (convenience sampling)**
- Exclusion of Generation Z members under 18.